

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 2
 ♥ K 8 2
 ♦ J 5
 ♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣K which you win with dummy's ♣A.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 4

You could come to your hand with the ♦A and finesse East for the ♥K. The problem with this idea is that even if the finesse works the ♥K probably wouldn't drop.

A better idea is to stay away from trumps until you ruff a ♦ loser in dummy. So you play the ♦K and everybody follows with small cards. Then play the ♦8, covered by West's ♦J, taken by your ♦A.

Next play your ♦3. West plays the ♦Q and you do what?

You ruff of course, that was the whole point of playing ♦s before trumps. But which card will you ruff with? Suppose you ruff with the ♥5 and West follows with another ♦. You could then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ to get to your hand, then ruff your last ♦ with dummy's ♥A. You would lose only the trump King and one ♣, making an overtrick.

Any problem with that? Yes, a big problem. West might be out of ♦s also. If you ruff with dummy's ♥5 West may overruff, then play a trump and you would not get any ♦ ruffs. Since you only need to ruff one ♦ in dummy to make the contract, it is safer to ruff with the ♥A. You will end up losing 1 ♣, 1 ♦ and the trump King.

Ruffing with the ♥A was the safe way to play the hand, and with this layout the only way to succeed.

Did you notice that East is a pretty good defender? Playing the ♦Q on the third round just might have convinced you that he was short in ♦s, in which case ruffing with the low trump would have been safe.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
 ♥ 9 5 3
 ♦ A K 9 5
 ♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East
on of your ♣ winners.

East is to play 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ A, then the ♥ K, then ♥ 10.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

The 2 ♥s are already lost, so you put your mind to the 2 ♣s. If the suit splits 3-3 the problem goes away, but a 4-2 split is more likely. So you should plan to ruff the fourth ♣ in dummy.

Ruff the third ♥. Then play ♣ A K 3. South discards a ♥ on the third ♣ which North wins. North will probably return his last ♣ at this point, hoping South can ruff higher than dummy's ♠9. But he cannot, so you ruff in dummy, pull trumps and claim the rest.

This was a good plan, pretty much guaranteed to work unless the ♣s split 5-1 so that somebody ruffed

But, it was a good plan because dummy held the ♠9. Keep that in mind when you look at Deal 15.

Board 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ J 5
♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5

N

W E

S

♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 8 7 6
♦ Q 10 3
♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10
♥ Q J
♦ 8 7
♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 10 4 2
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ Q 9

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 8 7 6
♦ Q 10 3
♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10
♥ Q J
♦ 8 7
♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 10 4 2
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ Q 9

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 11

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ J 5
♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7
♥ Q J 10 9 7 4
♦ A 6 3 2
♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4
♥ 6 3
♦ Q 10 9 7 4
♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3
♥ A 5
♦ K 8
♣ A 9 4 2

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 13

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ J 5
♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7
♥ Q J 10 9 7 4
♦ A 6 3 2
♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4
♥ 6 3
♦ Q 10 9 7 4
♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3
♥ A 5
♦ K 8
♣ A 9 4 2

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 8 7 6
♦ Q 10 3
♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10
♥ Q J
♦ 8 7
♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 10 4 2
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ Q 9

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 25

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ J 5
♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5

N

W E

S

♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 27

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 31

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 2
♥ K 8 2
♦ J 5
♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7
♥ Q J 10 9 7 4
♦ A 6 3 2
♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4
♥ 6 3
♦ Q 10 9 7 4
♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3
♥ A 5
♦ K 8
♣ A 9 4 2

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 10 4 2

♦ J 6 4 2

♣ Q 9

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 2

♥ K 8 2

♦ J 5

♣ 10 8 7 3

♠ 7

♥ Q J 10 9 7 4

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 10 4

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 7 4

♣ K Q J

♠ A 8 6 5 3

♥ A 5

♦ K 8

♣ A 9 4 2

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A K 9 5
♣ 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 8 7 6
♦ Q 10 3
♣ J 10 8 5



♠ A K Q J 10
♥ Q J
♦ 8 7
♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 4
♥ A K 10 4 2
♦ J 6 4 2
♣ Q 9